

Apple Cider-Brined Turkey

BRINE

- 12 cups apple cider
- 1 1/3 cup kosher salt
- 1 1/3 cup sugar
- 1 1/2 tablespoon black peppercorns, coarsely crushed
- 1 1/2 tablespoon whole allspice, coarsely crushed
- 12 (1/8-inch-thick) slices peeled fresh ginger
- 9 whole cloves
- 3 bay leaves
- 1 (20-pound) fresh or frozen turkey, thawed
- 3 oranges, quartered
- 9 cups ice
- 2 Turkey-sized oven bags

REMAINING INGREDIENTS:

- 6 garlic cloves
- 6 sage leaves
- 6 thyme sprigs
- 6 parsley sprigs
- 1 onion, quartered
- 1 1/2 (14-ounce) can fat-free, less-sodium chicken broth
- 3 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted and divided
- 1 1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper, divided
- 1 teaspoon salt, divided

MAKE BRINE THE NIGHT BEFORE putting in with the turkey...it takes a long time to cool!

Combine first 8 ingredients (through bay leaves) in a large saucepan; bring to a boil. Cook 5 minutes or until sugar and salt dissolve. Cool completely.

Remove giblets and neck from turkey; reserve for gravy if desired. Rinse turkey with cold water; pat dry. Trim excess fat. Stuff body cavity with orange quarters. Place a turkey-sized oven bag inside a second bag to form a double thickness. Place bags in a large stockpot. Place turkey inside inner bag. Add

cider mixture and ice. Secure bags with several twist ties. Refrigerate for 24 hours, turning occasionally.

Preheat oven to 500°.

Remove turkey from bags, and discard brine, orange quarters, and bags. Rinse turkey with cold water; pat dry. Lift wing tips up and over back; tuck under turkey. Tie legs together with kitchen string. Place garlic, sage, thyme, parsley, onion, and broth in the bottom of a roasting pan. Place roasting rack in pan. Arrange turkey, breast side down, on a roasting rack. Brush turkey back with 1 tablespoon butter; sprinkle with $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon pepper and $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon salt. Bake at 500° for 30 minutes.

Reduce oven temperature to 350°.

Remove turkey from oven. Carefully turn turkey over (breast side up) using tongs. Brush turkey breast with 1 tablespoon butter; sprinkle with $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon pepper and $\frac{1}{4}$ teaspoon salt. Bake at 350° for 1 hour and 15 minutes or until a thermometer inserted into meaty part of thigh registers 170° (make sure not to touch bone). (Shield the turkey with foil if it browns too quickly.) Remove turkey from oven; let stand 20 minutes. Reserve pan drippings for gravy if desired. Discard skin before serving.